

Pitch Your Idea (SparkTank)

A Shark-Tank-style startup pitch competition where teams present an original business or product idea to a panel of investor-judges and compete for funding-style prize money.

Rules & Specifications

Team Composition	Maximum 1 to 4 members per team. The pitched idea must be the original work of the presenting team.
Submission	A one-page executive summary and pitch deck (max 10 slides) must be submitted before the deadline for screening.
Pitch Format	• Elevator Pitch Round: 3-minute pitch, no Q&A (screening round). • Final Round: 5-minute stage pitch followed by a 5-minute Q&A with the judging panel ("Sharks").
Presentation Rules	Slide decks, physical prototypes, and printed handouts are allowed; no video longer than 30 seconds may be embedded in the pitch. Materials must be ready before the clock starts — nothing can be handed to judges once time begins.
Judging Criteria	• Originality & Innovation — 25% • Market Viability & Business Model — 25% • Financial Feasibility — 20% • Presentation & Q&A Handling — 30%
Conduct	Ideas deemed offensive, unethical, or plagiarized from an existing published venture will be disqualified. Judges' scoring decisions are final.

General Rules — Applicable to This Category

- **Strict Punctuality** — Teams must report to their arena, lab, stage, or table 15 minutes before their scheduled heat or session. Late arrival results in automatic forfeit.
- **Code of Conduct** — Abusive behavior, argument with judges leads to immediate disqualification.
- **Original Work** — Idea, presentations, designs, and all submissions must be the team's own original work produced within the stated contest window. Use of undisclosed pre-existing ventures leads to disqualification.
- **Judge's Decision** — The decision of the technical panel and judges is indisputable and final.

These rules are issued by the Capital Youth Expo organizing committee and apply alongside the master rulebook. The committee reserves the right to modify rules, time limits, or format if necessary. Judges' decisions are final and non-contestable.